

Del Rio

Del Rio, Texas
February 3, 1949

State Supt. L. A. Woods
Austin, Texas

Dear Mr. Woods:

I have been greatly influenced by the articles which appeared in the newspapers today concerning segregation in the Del Rio Schools.

I'm a girl of sixteen attending Sacred Heart Academy. I have never in my life attended any of the Del Rio High Schools, but this concerns me because I am a Latin-American and would like to have a say-so on obstacles arising among our people. I am very glad to say that in our school there has never been any segregation or favoring of anybody. The Anglo-Americans are outnumbered by Latin-Americans, but still everybody remains friendly.

I quote from today's San Antonio Evening News, "After registering at Anglo-American schools, the petition said, a number of Latin-American students later of their own accord transferred to Latin-American schools." What is it that the school officials call Latin-American Schools? Isn't this contradicting their statement that there has never been such a thing as segregation in their schools? Was this so called school made up or was it a result of Latin-Americans separated from others voluntarily? Choosing!! I hope the officials know what the word means. The children have never been given the privilege of choosing. What do they know about choosing, anyway? Anybody wants to be with the crowd, of course and this regulation was given to the school officials, not to the children. When registration dates were given, they didn't call for registration for Latin-Americans. No! They used a better term.---- Registration for West-End pupils.-- That would have been the same thing as saying-Registration for Mexicans-(as we are usually called,) since they are the only ones who have been inhabiting that school.

I have never heard of anyone having given the children of Latin-American ancestry the privilege of attending the school of their choice. Oh, where is the school's execution power? Aren't there any school rules or laws to be enforced? Why should the children be given so much liberty as to transfer from one school to another like the officials stated they had done? Why didn't the Anglo-Americans do any transferring? It is strictly impossible for anyone to agree with the Del Rio officials upon stating that the students were separated from Anglo-Americans because they chose to do so.

Let's take the high schools department situation. Did the Latin-American students choose, or did they have anything to choose from? I don't believe any of them said they wanted to be separated and still there is segregation among this group. There are clubs such as the Sub-Debs and the Seven Come Eleven. Latin-Americans have

never been permitted to join this clubs. A few have been granted the privilege of belonging to the football team and the pep squad is the only organization that some Latin-American girls belong to. But still after a football game everybody is invited to a celebration at Teen Town; that is everyone except the Latin-Americans. The fact that they took part in winning a game just as any other student at Del Rio High is completely forgotten after the game is over and from then on you just hear the phrase, "those Mexicans."

This and much more can convince me, you, and anyone else that segregation has really existed in the Del Rio High schools. This condition should not only be corrected in the elementary department, but also among high school students. Above all, we should always bear in mind that we were created by the One Being who wished to establish peace on earth among all creatures.

Respectfully yours,

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